

CLINICAL POLICY BULLETIN: ASTHMA MANAGEMENT

Policy Number: CPB-2026-ASTH-001 (SYNTHETIC)

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

1. Purpose

Medical necessity criteria for persistent asthma management in adults (18+), including step therapy and biologic authorization.

2. Coverage Criteria — Maintenance Therapy

Step 1 (Mild): Low-dose ICS (fluticasone 88-250 mcg/day). No prior auth.

Step 2 (Moderate): Medium-dose ICS or low-dose ICS + LABA. Requires inadequate control on Step 1 for 4 weeks.

Step 3 (Severe): High-dose ICS + LABA, consider LAMA. Requires Step 2 adherence for 3 months, ACT < 20.

3. Biologic Therapy Authorization

Covered when ALL met: severe persistent uncontrolled on high-dose ICS + LABA; documented adherence 6 months; minimum 2 exacerbations requiring systemic corticosteroids in 12 months; phenotype matching (eos $\geq$ 300 for mepolizumab); prior authorization by medical director.

4. Exclusions

Not covered: nebulizers without MDI inability documentation, brand-name when generic available, compounded meds without documented allergy.